PAID MEDIA · BUDGET CHECK

Paid Media Spend 2026 vs. the $300k budget

Platform data to 30 Sep 2026 · agency weekly reports to 11 Oct 2026 · USD (Google Ads converted at 1 EUR = 1.1177 USD) · prepared 13 Oct 2026 by Felipe Cárdenas

BUDGET 2026
$300,000
Maximum $320,000 · originally $350,000

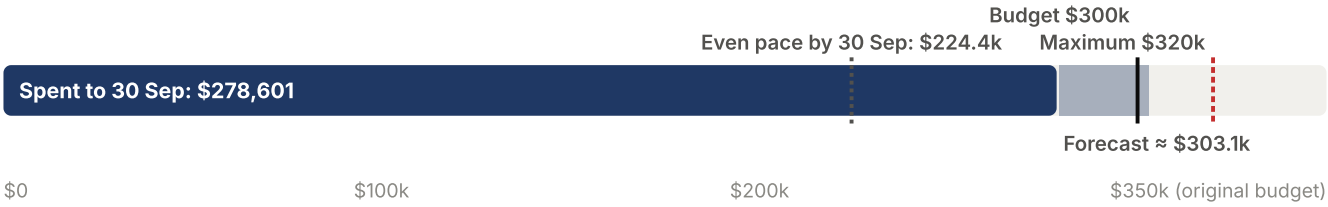
SPENT TO 30 SEP
$278,601
93% of the budget · 75% of the year gone

LEFT IN THE BUDGET
$21,399
≈ $1,628 a week to 31 Dec

LEFT UP TO THE MAXIMUM
$41,399
≈ $3,150 a week to 31 Dec

CURRENT PACE
$1,861 /week
Since the 18–21 Sep cuts (agency reports, last 3 weeks)

FORECAST YEAR-END
$303,058
≈ $3,058 over the budget · ≈ $16,942 under the maximum



What's flagged

Spending ran ahead of an even pace. $278,601 was spent by 30 Sep, $54,218 more than spreading $300k evenly over the year ($224,384). Q1 was the biggest quarter ($107,469).

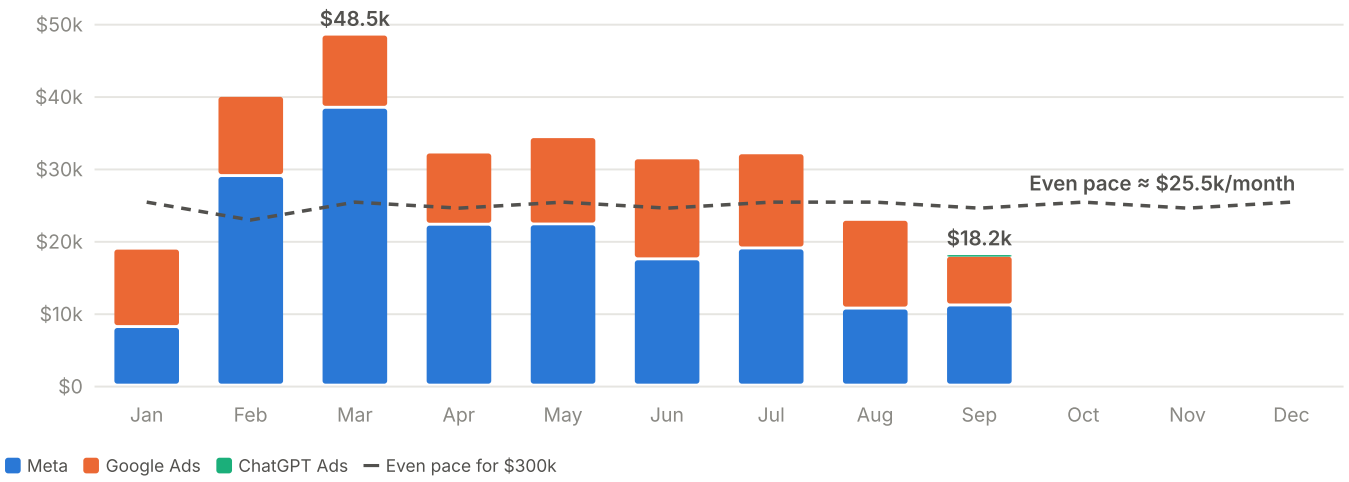
At the current pace, 2026 ends at ≈ $303,058: ≈ $3,058 over the budget and ≈ $16,942 under the maximum. Landing exactly on $300k means ≈ $1,628 a week (13% less than now).

The agency's reports don't match the platforms. Their H1 total is $182,516; the platforms show $205,432. Their July report converted Google's euros with a £→$ rate (×1.28), and three Google weeks look doubled.

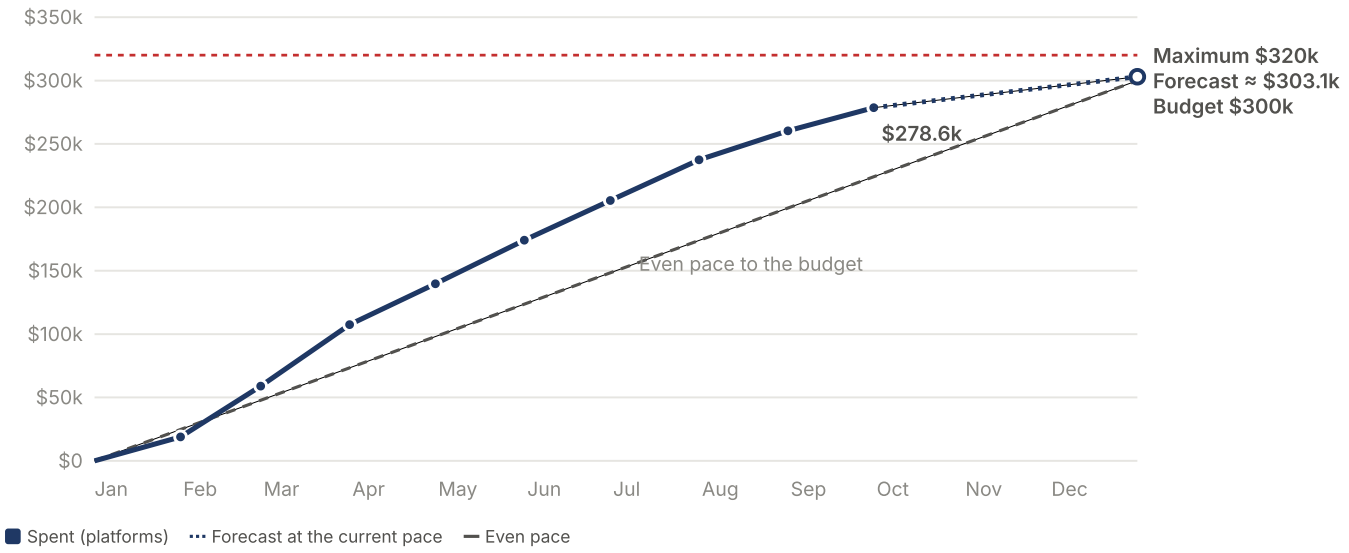
Lead numbers can't be compared over time. The agency changed the lead definition several times (leads, welcome conversions, proxy events), tracking was down ~15 Jul–11 Aug, and MQL/SQL reporting stopped after January.

Two budget questions are open: whether FR_Alibaba (run by PnP's internal team; $3,693 on Meta in September) and ChatGPT Ads ($257) count toward the $300k. Both are included here.

Spend by month and channel



Spend so far vs. budget and maximum



Quarter by quarter

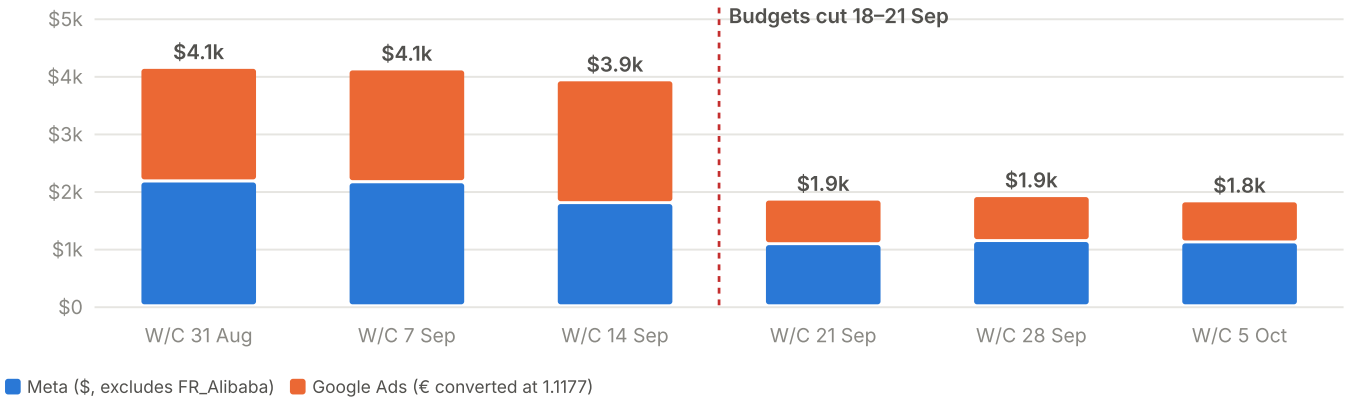
Quarter	Meta	Google	ChatGPT	Total	Even pace	Difference
Q1	$75,432	$32,036	–	**$107,469**	$73,973	+$33,496
Q2	$61,971	$35,992	–	**$97,964**	$74,795	+$23,169
Q3	$40,664	$32,249	$257	**$73,169**	$75,616	−$2,447
Total	**$178,067**	**$100,278**	**$257**	**$278,601**	**$224,384**	**+$54,218**

Where it went, by region

Region	Spent	Share
EMEA	$139,187	50%
Americas	$126,051	45%
Global	$13,107	5%

Region comes from the location code in each campaign name. Meta is 64% of all spend, Google Ads 36%.

Weekly spend around the September cuts (agency reports)



The agency's totals vs. the platform exports

Period	Agency said	Platforms	Difference	Note
February 2026	$38,762	$40,037	−$1,275	Close to the platforms, but not equal.
April 2026 – Meta	$24,586	$22,242	+$2,344	Higher than Meta's own figure for April.
April 2026 – Google	$11,420	$9,972	+$1,448	Equals Google's euros × 1.28 (a £→$ rate).
May 2026 – Meta	$22,276	$22,276	0	Matches Meta.
May 2026 – Google	$13,815	$12,064	+$1,752	Equals Google's euros × 1.28.
June 2026 – Meta	$17,453	$17,453	0	Matches Meta.
June 2026 – Google	$15,983	$13,956	+$2,027	Equals Google's euros × 1.28.
July 2026 – total	$34,014	$32,105	+$1,909	Meta matches; Google = euros × 1.28.
H1 2026 (Jan–Jun)	$182,516	$205,432	−$22,917	A second H1 page says $96,486.65, with data only to 24 Mar.

What's working

- The 18–21 Sep budget cuts took weekly spend from ≈ $4,057 to ≈ $1,861 (agency reports).
- Meta spend matches the agency's monthly figures for May–July, so the Meta history is solid.
- The new tracker uses one source (the platform exports), one currency (USD) and one budget, and will be updated every Monday.

What can be improved

- Agree one exchange rate with Finance (this report uses the 13 Oct live rate for all months).
- Fix one lead definition per channel and report HubSpot MQLs/SQLs by channel every week.
- Write down the monthly cap per channel and territory (the agency's location plan sits in an external sheet we haven't seen).

Next steps

1. Decide the Q4 pace with Tereza and Raúl: hold ≈ $1,861/week (≈ $303.1k), trim to ≈ $1,628/week ($300k), or go up to ≈ $3,150/week ($320k) where results justify it.
2. Confirm whether FR_Alibaba and ChatGPT Ads count toward the budget.
3. Ask Thiago before 30 Oct: Google's currency before 21 Sep, the doubled weeks, which H1 total is right, and the approved monthly caps.
4. Paste the daily platform exports (1 Jan – last Sunday) so the weekly view shows the whole year from platform data.

Sources: Meta ('Plug and Play Tech Center – Dollars' ad account, USD) and Google Ads (EUR) exports by campaign and month, 1 Jan – 30 Sep 2026; ChatGPT Ads 'Test 1' (23 Sep – 2 Oct, €229.56). Agency figures: weekly reports in Notion (W/C 29 Dec 2025 – 5 Oct 2026), copied as written; Google figures labelled $ before 21 Sep are treated as € because later reports show the same numbers in €. Budget: Tereza, 13 Oct 2026. Forecast = spent to 30 Sep + current weekly pace × 13.1 weeks left. Full detail: PNP_Paid_Media_Spend_Tracker_2026.xlsx.